BRING_BACK.EXE

Can you see a comeback coming?

This is a year of people searching for a product, before the brand said it was coming back. Would you bring it back?



Bring it back

Leave it

Answer on the last slide.

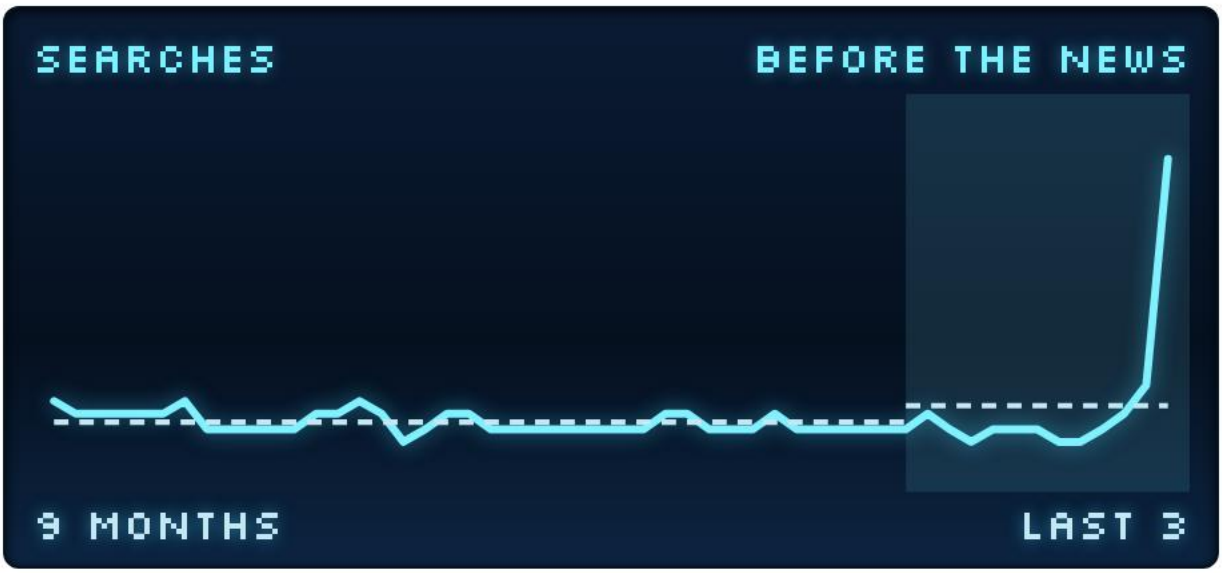
Brands bring things back all the time

Fans ask for a discontinued snack, a lip gloss, a sneaker. Sometimes the brand listens. Some stay for good. Some vanish again.

My question: if fans are already searching for it before the brand says a word, does that comeback last?

I sourced 42 real US comebacks from 2014 to 2025 in food and drink, beauty and sportswear, flops included, and measured the 26 with enough search data.

One number per comeback



1. Average searches in the last 3 months before the announcement (the right dashed line), divided by the 9 months before that (the left one).
2. Divide by the same number for the brand, so a brand that's growing anyway doesn't count.
3. Set the cut-off on 2014 to 2020. Test it once on 2021 to 2023.

Rules written and dated before any data was pulled. "Lasted" means still on sale two years later.

Oreo Cakesters



Still on sale two years on. Back on US shelves in early 2022 as a permanent line; Oreo was still making it in 2026 (after a recipe change).

The rule said	Called it
Bring it back	**Right**

Held out: the line was set without this case. Source: tastingtable.com

Line: US Google searches for the product. Number: its rise vs its brand. Attention, not sales.

Volcano Menu (Volcano Taco / Burrito)



Gone again within two years. Sold as a limited-time summer 2023 menu from June 29; no further run was found before March 2025.

The rule said	Called it
Bring it back	**Wrong**

Held out: the line was set without this case. Source: tacobell.com

Line: US Google searches for the product. Number: its rise vs its brand. Attention, not sales.

Nike Shox TL



Still on sale two years on. Nike kept adding Shox TL colourways at retail through 2024 and into 2025-2026.

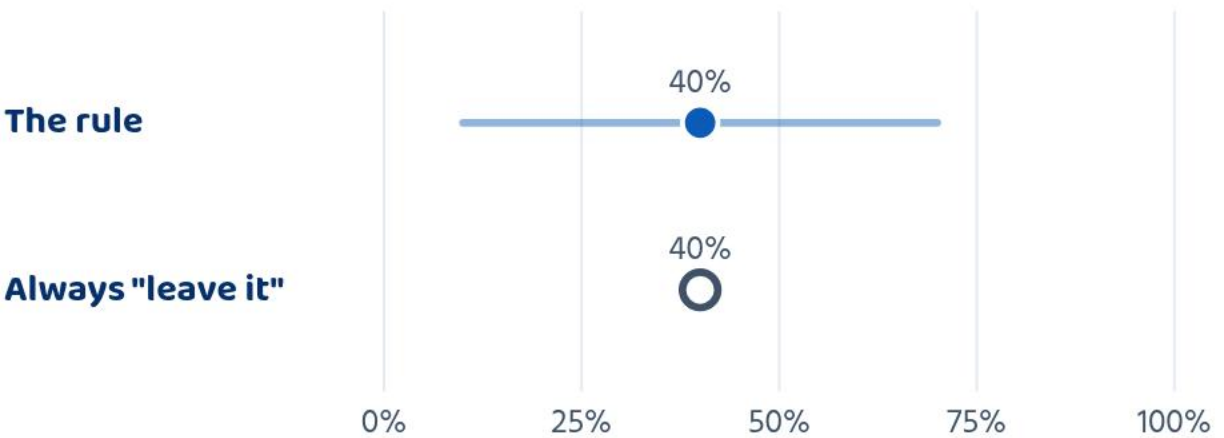
The rule said	Called it
Leave it	**Wrong**

Held out: the line was set without this case. Source: hypebeast.com

Line: Wikipedia views of the "Nike Shox" page (the whole line). Number: its rise vs its brand. Attention, not sales.

Buzz didn't pick the keepers

The rule called 4 of 10 held-out comebacks right. So did always saying "leave it". 6 of the 10 lasted, so always saying "bring it back" would have got 6.



Held-out hit rate with its 95% bootstrap range, n = 10. One case moves it 10 points, so treat it as a tie, not a verdict.

What I'd tell a brand team

1. **Early buzz is normal, not a green light.** Search interest was already rising, compared with the brand, before 18 of 22 comebacks, including 8 of 10 of the ones that faded.

2. **What I'd test next: does demand hold?** A limited run or a few regions might show whether people come back after the first spike.

3. **Also next: judge it after launch.** What happens once the novelty wears off may say more than the noise before it.

The first point is exploratory: found after the test, so it is a lead to check, not a result. The other two weren't tested here.

Your turn

Call three comebacks blind against the rule, then read the whole study: every case, every source, and the 4 I've called for 2027.

The sneakers I've called: Puma Speedcat OG, bring it back. Nike Total 90 (T90 III), bring it back. Check back in 2027.

Slide 1 was Mexican Pizza. Still on sale two years on.

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Sportswear is only 2 of the 22 scored comebacks: several sneaker returns were too thin in search data to measure, and others couldn't be dated. Start menu, then Comeback study. Study by Tahsin Anan, with research and build support.